# Robert Heideman

Bicycle Technician | Workshop Lead | Skills Mentor

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## PROFILE

I've been riding bikes since I was two, and at 14 I landed my first job building bikes at my local bike shop over the summer holidays. I've worked as a mechanic ever since, from the end of high school and all through university. When I started my career as a Prosthetist-Orthotist, I kept the bikes going, working on my own and travelling as a tour mechanic with Wide Open Road Cycling in Europe, Japan and Australia. In 2020, during COVID, I started my own bike brand, Heiden Cycle Works, designing and building custom bespoke bikes myself. I've also created and adapted bikes for people with disabilities. What I enjoy most is passing on what I know, and I'd love to bring that to PUSH!, helping young people build their own bikes and the confidence that comes with it.

## KEY SKILLS

- **Bicycle mechanics:** full servicing, diagnosis and repair of road, mountain, hybrid, kids' and e-bikes; complete builds from the frame up; wheel truing, brake and gear adjustment, drivetrain servicing, cable replacement, hubs and bearings.
- **Adaptive bikes:** creating and adapting bikes for people with disabilities, drawing on my orthotics background.
- **Safety checks and refurbishment:** inspecting and refurbishing second-hand bikes so they're safe and roadworthy, and making the most of donated and recycled parts.
- **Workshop management:** running fixed and mobile workshops on my own, including tool and equipment upkeep, parts and stock, and WHS practices such as risk assessments and equipment checks.
- **Teaching and mentoring:** mentoring junior and new technicians, and breaking complex tasks into simple, achievable steps. I'm patient, encouraging and good at building confidence.
- **Making and fabrication:** carbon frame building, design and problem-solving, including Fusion 360 CAD and 3D printing (FDM, SLA, SLS). I love inventing, building and improving things.

## BICYCLE INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

**Founder / Frame Builder and Bicycle Technician** 2020 – Present

*Heiden Cycle Works, Brisbane QLD*

- Founded the business. I design and build custom bicycle frames from carbon tubes joined with 3D-printed lugs, which I design myself.
- Build, service and repair all kinds of bikes, from entry-level commuters to high-end race bikes.
- Diagnose faults, quote the work and complete repairs to a high safety standard.
- Run every part of the business, including customer service, sourcing and ordering parts, workshop and tool upkeep, and accounts.

**Travelling Tour Mechanic** 2016 – Present (tours each year)

*Wide Open Road Cycling*

- Travel with multi-day cycling tours in Europe, Japan and Australia each year and maintain every bike on the tour.
- Do daily safety checks, servicing and roadside repairs from a mobile workshop, often with limited tools and parts.
- Friendly, helpful point of contact for riders of all abilities, keeping them safe and riding.

**Bicycle Mechanic** 2009 – 2015

*The Ride Cycles, Kew VIC*

- Workshop mechanic in a busy retail bike shop: servicing, repairs, new bike builds and customer service.

**Volunteer Mechanic – Great Victorian Bike Ride** 2008 – 2015

*Warrandyte High School, VIC*

- Registered mechanic for the school's student team over eight years, keeping students' bikes running on a multi-day ride.
- Worked alongside students and teachers, keeping young riders safe and on the road.

**Volunteer Mechanic and Support Crew – Lesa Ashford** 2023

*Solo world-record attempt: first and fastest woman to cycle around Australia*

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE – PROSTHETICS AND ORTHOTICS

**Sole Owner / Principal Orthotist** Oct 2026 – Present
*Roam Orthotics*

- See participants for assessment, goal setting and treatment planning, liaising with carers and allied health.
- Scan, model and create custom orthoses using CAD, 3D printing and traditional hand fabrication.
- Fit and implement devices, train participants and carers in their use, and provide reviews and adjustments.
- Run the whole practice: referrals, bookings, NDIS and funding reports, quotes and accounts.

**Senior Orthotist** Jan 2026 – Sep 2026
*Ability Made*

- Helped young people with disabilities achieve their goals and greater independence through custom orthotic care.
- Held senior responsibilities, including mentoring and supporting other clinicians.

**Senior Prosthetist/Orthotist** May 2025 – Mar 2026
*Princess Alexandra Hospital, Woolloongabba QLD*

- Manage complex inpatient and outpatient cases as part of a multidisciplinary team, and lead quality assurance projects.

**Senior Orthotic Technician and Head of Digital Design** Jan 2024 – Present
*Queensland Orthotic Lab, Capalaba QLD*

- Hands-on fabrication in a busy production workshop. I mentor and train junior and new technicians.
- Introduced 3D scanning, modelling and printing into the lab's manufacturing process.

**Senior Clinical Orthotist and Technician** Oct 2018 – Mar 2023
*Orthotic Motion Pty Ltd, Geelong VIC*

**Prosthetist-Orthotist and Technician** Aug 2017 – Aug 2018
*Drevelin Ortopedi AB, Bergen, Norway*

**Prosthetist-Orthotist and Technician** Feb 2016 – Aug 2017
*Optopedia Ortopediteknisk AS, Stockholm, Sweden*

## EDUCATION AND TRAINING

**Bachelor of Health Science / Master of Clinical Prosthetics and Orthotics** 2012 – 2015
*La Trobe University, Bundoora VIC*

**Cultural Exchange Program** Jan 2014 – Jul 2014
*Jönköping University, Sweden*

- **Professional development:** founding member, Digital Limb Collective; 2016 ISPO European Congress.

## COMMUNITY AND VOLUNTEERING

- Veterans International Cambodia, Phnom Penh (2015): built and fitted low-cost prostheses with limited resources.
- Regular volunteer at Edgar's Mission animal sanctuary, Lancefield VIC.
- Oxfam Trailwalker, Taupō NZ (2013): our team raised $15,000.
- Relay For Life participant (2009–2012); Australian Red Cross door-knock appeal volunteer (2009–2013).

## OTHER INFORMATION

- **Screening checks:** current Queensland Blue Card (held a Working with Children Check for 10+ years) and current NDIS Worker Screening Check (Yellow Card).
- **Languages:** English (native), Swedish and Norwegian (proficient).
- **Computer skills:** Microsoft Word, Excel, Outlook and PowerPoint; Fusion 360; HTML and CSS.
- **Interests:** road, mountain, track and triathlon cycling. I've completed Ironman Melbourne, the 3 Peaks Challenge and the Otway Odyssey. I also enjoy surfing, skiing and camping.

## REFERENCES

**Clare Holdsworth**
Owner and Tour Operator, Wide Open Road Cycle Tours
wideopenroadcycletours@gmail.com

**Liz Heagney**
Office Manager, Queensland Orthotic Lab Pty Ltd
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